

Open Gateway Hackathon 2026 - Challenge

Introduction

Welcome to Talent Arena 2026! The most important event dedicated to digital talent in Europe is back and ready to gather countless professionals, top companies and educational institutions from the tech sector.

For the next three days, the entire ecosystem is pushing the boundaries to prove that we are capable of big things. And a good way to achieve this goal is to get digital professionals joining forces with tech organisations in ventures like this one: **the 3rd edition of the Open Gateway Hackathon!**

What is Open Gateway?

Open Gateway is a global initiative led by the GSMA (Global System for Mobile Communications Association) that aims to transform communication networks into platforms. This process allows telecom capabilities to be opened in an interoperable, intuitive and programmable way through **standardized APIs** under the CAMARA project.

What is the goal of this competition?



The main objective of this competition is to **create a new use case**, leveraging these APIs, that delivers high value for the target clients in some tech field, such as:

- End customers/consumers
- Enterprise customers
- Application development
- Content and gaming development
- Software development
- The telecom industry (e.g., operators and suppliers)
- Regulators

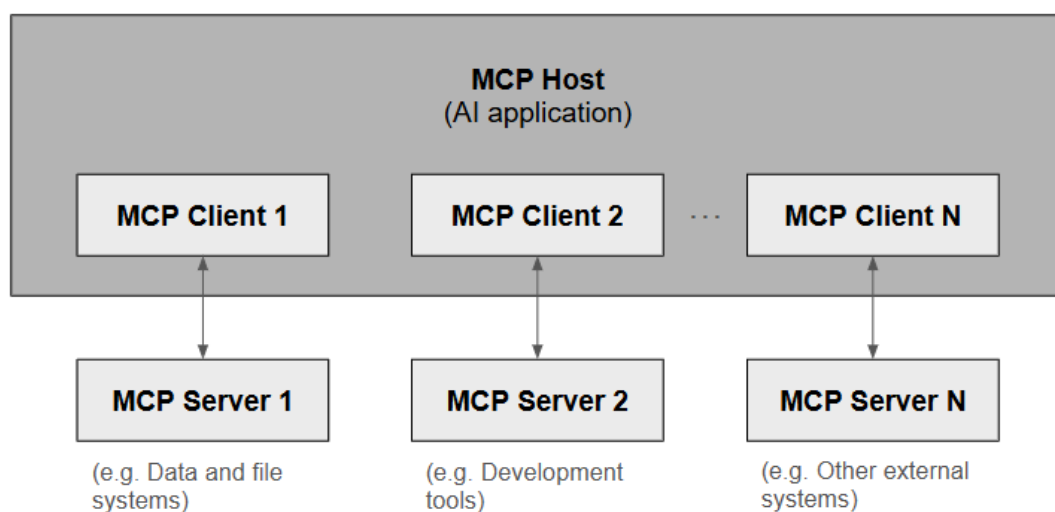
Additionally, participants will not only need to innovate but also develop. Each team must **build a semi-functional Proof of Concept (PoC)** ready for deployment using the APIs proposed in this challenge.

Bonus task: Integrating AI

Due to huge recent advancements, Artificial Intelligence (AI) is being integrated into a myriad of processes across multiple industries, and everyone agrees on the fact that it is here to stay. That is the reason why we encourage the hackathon participants to create solutions powered by AI, such as:

- Agentic apps
- Workflow automations
- Tools and data sources integrations

One of the latest and most successful initiatives in this sector is the creation of an open standard that enables tech professionals to connect their AI applications to external systems: [Model Context Protocol](#). This standard follows a client-server architecture where an MCP host (an AI application) establishes connections to one or more MCP servers, by creating one MCP client for each MCP server.



[Software Development Kits](#) (SDKs) are being created so that developers can build MCP servers and clients according to the standard. Each SDK provides the same core functionality but follows the idioms and best practices of its language. All SDKs support:

- Creating MCP servers that expose tools, resources, and prompts
- Building MCP clients that can connect to any MCP server
- Local and remote transport protocols
- Protocol compliance with type safety

We invite the participants to assimilate all this information and to leverage some of the infinite AI capabilities to build even more astonishing solutions.

In addition to MCP, participants can also use Google-provided Gemini models (you will have free access to the models during the hackathon). Alternatively, you may refer to publicly available LLMs from Ollama, Hugging Face or other providers.

Teams

To ensure a balanced skill set, multidisciplinary teams have been formed consisting of:

- **Backend Developer:** Responsible for creating the logic that underpins the team's proposal.
- **Frontend Developer:** Responsible for designing and developing the user interface and experience.
- **Full Stack Developer:** Responsible for supporting both backend and frontend as needed.
- **Business Manager / Product Owner:** Responsible for shaping the business idea, in collaboration with the rest of the team, on which the project will be based. They must focus on studying feasibility, target users and target market related to the proposed solution.

Resources

For the development of this challenge, participants will have access to NOKIA's [Network as Code](#) platform, where the following resources will be available:

- API keys
- API sandboxes
- [Documentation](#)
- ... and many more!

The next steps for accessing and navigating our API Hub are stated below:

1. **Log in to the hub:** Please log in to the [Network as Code](#) platform.
2. **Switch to your organization:** In the dashboard navigation bar, you'll see a dropdown menu where you can change from your personal test organisation to the Nokia-created team organisation for the hackathon.
3. **Explore APIs:** Browse, test and find code snippets for all available APIs.
4. **More details:** You can find more information in our documentation: [Docs | Network as Code](#).

And finally, the three telecom operators **Movistar, Orange and Vodafone** have provisioned the participants with **SIM/eSIM cards** so that their projects can be tested under realistic conditions by connecting them to **live 5G networks**. These SIM/eSIM cards can be used by

5G-enabled devices the participants may have brought to the competition, such as mobile phones, modems or any other relevant hardware that may enhance their projects.

If the participants couldn't bring any 5G-enabled device, they can get one from the organisation of the event.

Available APIs

For this challenge, the following APIs are available using live network connection by each telecom operator:

API	Orange	Vodafone	Telefonica
SIM Swap	X	X	X
Device Swap	X	X	X
Know Your Customer (KYC) Match	X	X	X
Location Retrieval	X	X	X
Location Verification	X	X	X
Number Verification	X	X	X
Device Status	X	X	X
Know Your Customer (KYC) Age	X	X	X
Know Your Customer (KYC) Tenure	X	X	X
Know Your Customer (KYC) Fill-in	X	X	X
Quality-of-service on Demand (QoD)	X	X	X
Geofencing	X	X	X
Call Forwarding	X	X	X
Number Recycling	X	X	X

In addition to the previous ones, other NOKIA APIs can also be accessed using simulator phone numbers.

Google Cloud resources

We are so happy to share that Google is providing each participant with a full-access account to Google Cloud platform! This extremely valuable resource offers the opportunity to use amazing tools such as Gemini CLI, Cloud Run or Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE).

Further details related to getting access to these resources will be provided on Monday morning during the hackathon.

Tech stack

Any programming languages, libraries and frameworks can be used. Each team must agree on the technologies they will use to complete the challenge.

Hackathon objectives

1. Designing a new feasible and marketable use case **using at least 2 of the proposed APIs.**
2. Developing the **backend logic** of the proposed solution.
3. Developing the **frontend UI** to make the solution intuitive and user-friendly.
4. **Pitching** the solution created by the team (max. 5 minutes).

Event development

This event will take place on March 2nd and 3rd. All teams will have access to the Network as Code platform and will have to:

- Read the proposed documentation.
- Understand how the platform works.
- Propose a new use case.
- Design and develop everything necessary for the PoC.

All teams must complete the development of the proposed solution before March 3rd at 11:00, when the first pitching evaluation phase will take place. The finalists from this first phase will pitch again at 16:00 during the second pitching evaluation phase in front of the telecom jury members.

The awards ceremony will take place on March 3rd at 17:30 during the Open Gateway DevCon at Talent Arena.

Evaluation criteria

The aspects to consider when preparing the pitch and developing the project are divided into two blocks and stated below:

BUSINESS

1. **Business Relevance:** Identifying tangible value for both customers and stakeholders. Measuring potential business impact that justifies the resources required (ROI).
2. **Commercial Viability:** Evaluating whether the idea can become a viable solution from a commercial point of view. Considering the business model, target market, value proposition and the number of people or companies benefited.
3. **Clarity and Presentation:** Considering how the business proposal is presented. Evaluating the clarity of the presentation, the effectiveness of communicating ideas and the proposed strategy for implementing the solution.

TECHNOLOGY

1. **Technical Innovation:** Evaluating how and how effectively the team has leveraged the GSMA APIs and AI, innovative methods of integrating these resources and creative solutions to technical problems.
2. **Demonstration and Prototype (PoC):** Considering the quality and effectiveness of the developed prototype. Evaluating if it clearly demonstrates the proposed functionality and its technical feasibility.
3. **Sustainability and Scalability:** Evaluating if the technical solution is sustainable in the long term and if it can be scaled to handle growth in usage or demand.

Use case examples

A) Remote driving

[Enhancing Connectivity for Remote Driving with Network as Code and Elmo Cars](#)

Navigating crowded areas may present significant challenges to remote driving vehicles. Network issues and peak time overload can compromise safety under these circumstances by degrading video quality and making it difficult for remote drivers to clearly see the road, surroundings and traffic signals.

To overcome this challenge, the teledriving Elmo company integrated Nokia's Quality of Service on Demand (QoD) capability from the Network as Code platform. This capability dynamically adjusts the network to ensure connectivity for Elmo cars, guaranteeing that even during periods of high network traffic, the cars receive the high-quality video feed necessary for safe operation. Network as Code also enables critical device status and network insights, offering valuable information about device connectivity and potential network issues.

Additionally, Nokia's Network as Code (NaC) serves as an aggregator, allowing for

the seamless management of connections through a single interface, regardless of the network provider or country.



B) Incident response and workplace security improvement

[Nokia, Radisys and Innova Solutions develop network API-powered worker safety solution with Orange](#)

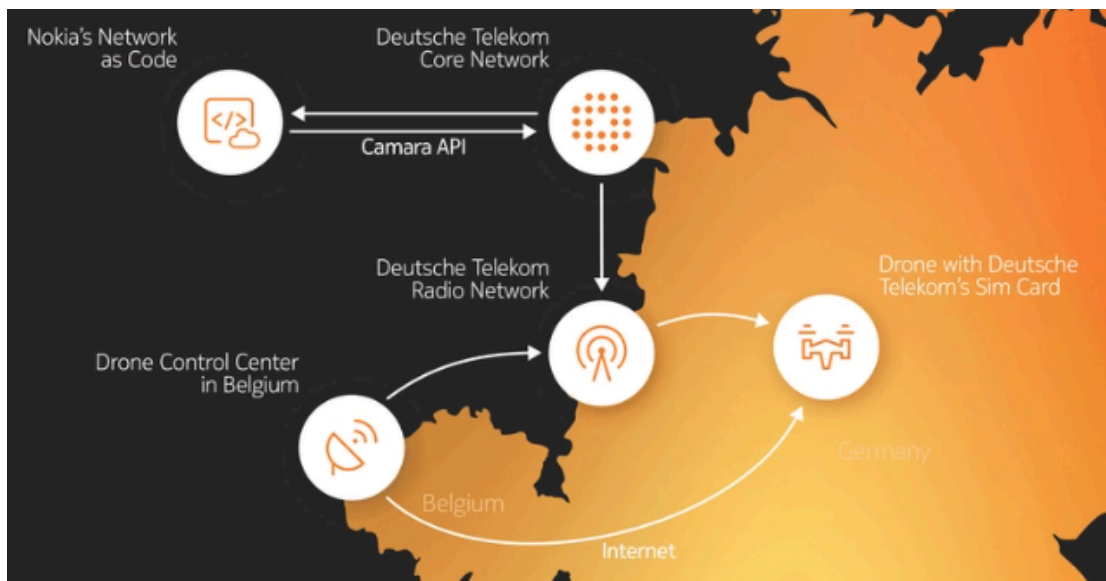
Worker safety continues to be a top priority for enterprises. By integrating advanced network APIs, new solutions are being developed to enhance real-time incident response, ensuring worker safety in critical situations. Quality of Service on Demand (QoS) and Device Location APIs enable a seamless and efficient incident response system.

When an incident, such as a fire, is detected through video analytics, the Quality of Service on Demand (QoS) API boosts uplink bandwidth, ensuring uninterrupted, high-quality video streaming from the 5G cameras at the affected location. In addition, the Device Location API determines the location of individuals in the affected area. Workers in danger can be sent real-time notifications to evacuate the area, and the incident response team can be dispatched to the location of the problem.



C) Cross-country remote drone operations

[Nokia and Deutsche Telekom Enhance Drone Connectivity](#)



D) Financial security protection

[Preventing Fraud in Banking with Network as Code and Wave XD](#)

